

PEIYI JIN

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RESEARCH INTEREST

Fintech, Household Finance

ACADEMIC EMPLOYMENT

Princeton University

Research Fellow, DeCenter

Princeton, NJ, USA

Sep. 2026 - Current

EDUCATION

National University of Singapore

Doctor of Philosophy in Economics.

Ph.D. Dissertation: Risks and Impacts of Digital Technologies on Financial Markets

Singapore

2026

Cornell University

Visiting PhD Student in Cornell SC Johnson College of Business

Ithaca, NY, USA

2025

Southwestern University of Finance and Economics

B.Sc. in Financial Engineering

Sichuan, China

2020

University of California, Berkeley

Visiting Undergraduate in Economics

Berkely, CA, USA

2019

REFERENCES

Sumit Agarwal (Head of committee)

Low Tuck Kwong Distinguished Professor
of Finance

Professor of Economics and Real Estate

NUS Business School

National University of Singapore

Director, Sustainable and Green Finance Institute

President, Asian Bureau of Finance and Economic Research

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Eswar Prasad

Tolani Senior Professor of Trade Policy

Professor of Economics

Charles H. Dyson School of Applied Economics and Management

Cornell University

Senior Fellow, Brookings Institution (New Century Chair
in International Economics)

Research Associate, NBER

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Ben Charoenwong

Associate Professor of Finance (without tenure)
INSEAD

Affiliated Faculty, NUS FinTech Lab

Asian Institute of Digital Finance

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Daniel Rabetti

Visiting Assistant Professor

Harvard Business School

Assistant Professor of Accounting and Finance

S. Dhanabalan Chair in Quantitative Studies

NUS Business School

National University of Singapore

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RESEARCH

► 1. When Privacy Protects but Excludes: The Costs and Benefits of Privacy Regulation in Credit Markets (R&R at *Review of Financial Studies*)

with Sumit Agarwal, Pulak Ghosh, Shohini Kundu, Nishant Vats, Xinbo Wang, and Yingze Xu

- **Abstract:** This paper studies the consequences of privacy regulation by exploiting Google's 2019 restriction on CDR access for a major Indian FinTech lender. We show that this intervention reflects a key policy trade-off in digital credit markets: strengthened privacy protections raise loan applications, consistent with higher demand, yet simultaneously induce tighter screening, reflecting an overall contraction in credit supply. This credit contraction disproportionately excludes economically and socially marginalized applicants. Linking to economy-wide credit bureau records, we quantify the "FinTech ladder effect" whereby initial digital credit access serves as a gateway to broader formal credit. Privacy-induced rejection reduces the probability of obtaining any formal credit by 13.7 percentage points even four years later. Using a structural model, we decompose the welfare effects of privacy regulation and show that the regulation generates a 0.53% increase in consumer surplus and reduces lender profits by 15%.
- **Coverage:** [CEPR VoxEU](#), April 2026.

► 2. Crypto Capture of Foreign Aid (NBER Working Paper No. w35655)

with Sumit Agarwal, Eswar Prasad, and Daniel Rabetti

- **Abstract:** The 2016 Panama Papers leak tightened regulatory enforcement around money laundering and offshore banking. We investigate whether the diversion of foreign aid in developing countries led to a shift to cryptocurrency as an alternative laundering platform. We develop a disbursement-timed forensic measure of cryptocurrency activity, combining on-chain Bitcoin transactions and wallet creation, off-chain exchange records, and IP-linked web traffic, and apply it to World Bank aid disbursements covering \$238 billion across the 93 recipient countries in our estimation

sample during 2018-2024. Exploiting the administrative timing of aid tranche arrivals, we find sharp, short-lived surges of crypto activity at the disbursement month, driven mainly by anonymous and newly created wallets on both tax-haven and mainstream exchanges. Blockchain forensics reveal patterns consistent with the placement, layering, and integration sequence of conventional money laundering. We estimate an implied leakage of 2 to 6 cents per aid dollar, which amounts to roughly 1.7 to 4.3 billion dollars of aid diversion across the tranche arrivals we study. Capture carries no funding penalty: the four sectors where we detect it, Transport, Water and Sanitation, Social Protection, and Governance, still absorb half of subsequent World Bank funding. Cryptocurrency facilitates aid diversion, but its transparent ledgers also leave forensic traces that may help detect and recover diverted funds.

- **Coverage:** [Financial Times](#), August 2026.

► 3. Digital Salience and Consumption Elasticity: Evidence from a Real-Time Feedback Intervention (JMP)

solo-authored

- **Abstract:** This paper studies how digital technologies alter household responsiveness to income shocks by increasing the salience of consumption. I evaluate a government-led intervention in Singapore that provides real-time energy usage feedback through a mobile app. Using proprietary banking transaction data and a staggered rollout design, I find that treated households reduce utility payments by approximately \$21 per month. This reduction is not driven by price changes or liquidity constraints but by increased cognitive attention to consumption. The intervention also produces behavioral spillovers: households reduce spending on paper goods, carbon-intensive foods, and taxi rides. Untreated residents living near treated areas exhibit similar changes, suggesting that salience effects diffuse spatially. These findings challenge the Permanent Income Hypothesis by showing that visibility increases short-run consumption elasticity. The results have implications for monetary and fiscal policy design. Digital salience can raise marginal propensities to consume, especially among liquidity-constrained households, and may strengthen policy transmission in heterogeneous-agent macroeconomic models.

► 4. Non-cognitive Development and Peer Effects: Experimental Evidence from Chinese Rural Boarding School Students

with Yue Li

- **Abstract:** We study the direct and spillover effects of a low-cost socio-emotional intervention: 15-minute audio bedtime stories broadcast in the dormitories of 63 randomly assigned rural Chinese primary schools. Only boarders are directly exposed; day students share their classrooms. Treated boarders show modest noncognitive gains, while untreated day students gain more, including 0.16 standard deviations in self-esteem by 2017. The spillover concentrates among left-behind children of migrant parents and does not require a pre-existing friendship with a treated boarder. It is accompanied by shifts in friendship composition and by improvements in peer climate, school belonging, and perceived teacher support.

TEACHING EXPERIENCES

- Teaching Assistant, Money and Banking, undergrad level, NUS 2023
- Teaching Assistant, Money and Banking, undergrad level, NUS 2022
- Instructor, Junior Achievement Economics Workshop, high school level, SWUFE 2017

PRESENTATIONS

- American Finance Association 2027
- AEA, AFA PhD Session, European Finance Association, ABFER, Midwest Finance Association, Financial Management Association, CAERE 2026
- ABR-Fudan Conference, 38th Australasian Finance and Banking Conference PhD Forum 2025
- Tsinghua University Brownbag (SEM and PBC), NUS Accounting Brownbag 2024
- AI Global Finance Research Conference; 29th International Conference on Computing in Economics and Finance (CEF); Asian Meeting of the Econometric Society; NUS Economics Brownbag 2023

HONORS

- **Research Funding, Asian Institute of Digital Finance, NUS (SGD 160K)**
Project: Examining the Effects of Digital Private Information Exposure on Fintech Lender and Borrower Behaviors Jun.2024-Jun.2025
- Research Scholarship, Department of Economics, NUS Aug.2024-Aug.2025
- Research Scholarship, Ministry of Education (MOE), Singapore Aug.2020-Aug.2024
- Undergraduate Exchange Scholarship, SWUFE Jan.2020-May.2020
- Outstanding Undergraduate Exchange Students, China Scholarship Council (CSC) Aug.2018-May.2019
- Academic Scholarship (SWUFE) Sep.2017-Jun.2018

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Reviewer for Review of Corporate Finance, Hawaii Accounting Research Conference